

DO WE HAVE FREE WILL?

Free will means being free to make choices for ourselves without something or someone restricting us. Most of us assume that we have it, but many philosophers believe that we don't have free will. Instead, they think that our actions are influenced or determined by forces beyond our control. If this is the case, who or what is in charge? Feel free to take a guess.

FREE TO FOLLOW



"WE ARE NOT FREE TO ACT OUTSIDE THE LAWS OF NATURE. EVERYTHING IS PREDICTABLE."



DETERMINISM

Some philosophers argue that, like everything in the universe, every human action is determined by previous events going back in an unbroken chain to the beginning of time. As they believe that all events have been predetermined, determinism is considered to be incompatible with the notion of free will.



FREEDOM TO ACT

A separate philosophical argument accepts that people are bound by the laws of nature but instead stresses that these laws do not compel them to make particular choices. It is up to personal choice as to whether or not to eat a pumpkin, for example. No one is forcing you to do it.



"I AM RESPONSIBLE FOR MY OWN ACTIONS. THE CHOICE IS MINE TO MAKE."